# ROBIN YIFAN LUO

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## EDUCATION

**University of Washington, Seattle**, Ph.D. in Finance *Expected June 2027*

**University of British Columbia**, M.Sc. in Finance *2021*

**Hong Kong University of Science and Technology**, M.Sc. in Economics *2019*

**University of Nottingham**, B.Sc. with Honours in Economics *2018*

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Financial Intermediation, Corporate Finance, Industrial Organization

## JOB MARKET PAPER

**Misallocation in Banking**, solo-authored *Draft available upon request*

I develop and estimate a two-sided oligopolistic model of U.S. banking to measure how uneven bank pricing power misallocates deposits and loans. Estimated misallocation falls over time, with deposit-loan complementarities offsetting a substantial share. The framework also evaluates how competition, mergers, monetary tightening, and banking stress shift banks relative to efficient allocation benchmarks.

## PUBLICATION

**In Search of a Unicorn: Dynamic Agency with Endogenous Investment Opportunities**, with Felix Zhiyu Feng and Beatrice Michaeli

*Journal of Accounting and Economics*, 2024. [SSRN]

We develop a dynamic contracting model in which privately observed opportunities arrive through costly search. The optimal contract generates time-varying investment thresholds, internal search charges, and empirically testable overinvestment patterns.

## WORKING PAPERS

**The Optimal Schedules of Incentives and Cash Flows**, with Felix Zhiyu Feng and Mark M. Westerfield

We study delegated management when observable output combines investment in durable asset quality and instantaneous effort. Optimal incentives begin back-loaded and can become front-loaded as promised future incentives accumulate, generating cash-flow mean reversion and implications for the duration of incentives.

**Clientele Specialization, Stable Capital, and Value in Asset Management**, with Hossein Poorvasei

Using data on 4,391 U.S. separately managed account products, we document that clientele specialization predicts more durable funding, more stable exposures, and higher gross-of-fee alpha. A model links relationship-specific investment to funding stability, scale, and the division of gains between managers and clients.

## WORK IN PROGRESS

**Money-Market Capacity and the Funding Channel of Monetary Policy**, with Germán Gutiérrez and Hossein Poorvasei

We show that the cost banks pay to replace deposits with wholesale funding during monetary tightening is not a fixed friction but depends on money-market capacity. It rises more steeply when capacity is scarce, only for unsecured funding, and passes through to bank lending.

**The Industrial Organization of Safe Savings**, with Germán Gutiérrez and Hossein Poorvasei

We show that deposit betas are equilibrium outcomes of a market in which differentiated bank products compete with money funds, Treasury bills, and cash. Estimating deposit demand for the universe of U.S. banks, we find that the pass-through of policy rates to the marginal value of deposit funding is far below one, and that competition within a bank's own product menu, more so than rivalry between banks, generates most of the observed pass-through.

**Production Functions in Asset Management**, with Ahmed Guecioueur

## TEACHING AND STUDENT ENGAGEMENT

**Teaching Assistant, University of Washington** *2022–2026*

- EMBA 520: Financial Management, for Jonathan Karpoff
- EMBA 540: International Finance, for Stephan Siegel

Median rating of 4.7/5.0 across seven Executive MBA sections (range 4.5–4.9).
Recipient of EMBA Teaching Recognition Award.

## PRESENTATIONS

*Conferences and invited seminars (* presented by coauthor)*

**2026:** Finance Theory Group Fall Meeting*, FMA Annual Meeting, FIRS Conference*, Econometric Society North American Summer Meeting*

**2025:** Financial Theory Group Summer School, Southwest Finance Association, Eastern Finance Association*

**2023:** CES North America Conference, Journal of Accounting and Economics conference*, Organizational Economics Workshop*, 33rd Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory*

**2022:** Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference*, Research Symposium on Finance and Economics, Asia-Pacific Association of Derivatives, Australasian Finance & Banking Conference, China International Conference in Finance*, HKUST Accounting Research Symposium*

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

**Ph.D. Student Mentor, UW Foster** *2024–2026*

**Doctoral Business Students Association Representative, UW Foster** *2025*

**Co-Organizer, Finance Ph.D. Brownbag, UW Foster** *2022–2024*

## AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Dean's Achievement Award, UW Foster
EMBA Teaching Recognition Award, UW Foster
UW Ph.D. Fellowship

## SKILLS AND INTERESTS

**Programming:** R, MATLAB, Python, Stata, SQL, LaTeX
**Languages:** Mandarin (native), English (fluent), French (basic), Cantonese (basic)
**Interests:** Hiking, bouldering, concerts, acoustic guitar

## REFERENCES


**Mark M. Westerfield (Chair)**
Professor of Finance and Business Economics, Michael G. Foster Endowed Professor
University of Washington
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**Philip Bond**
Professor of Finance and Business Economics, Edward E. Carlson Distinguished Professor in Business Administration
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**Germán Gutiérrez**
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